



Production Diary | Music Video
“Spineless”

Course Name: Digital Cinematography
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Submitted to

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Production Diary

Music Video on Helden (Heroes) by David Bowie

Course Supervisor: Nibras Bin Syed

Director & Cinematographer: Ebsan Zaman Dipto

Director's Vision

This project explores the psychological and social journey of an unemployed man navigating frustration, hope, and continuous struggle. The character aspires to become a “hero” within his own limited world, yet the harshness of the corporate system repeatedly marginalizes him.

At a breaking point, his accumulated frustration transforms into a symbolic act of rebellion. However, this “revolution” results in no structural change; the system remains intact, indifferent. The narrative emphasizes a critical idea: while individuals in power may change, the system itself remains rigid and unaltered.

Despite this failure, the character returns to the cycle of survival, holding onto a fragile sense of hope. The project aligns with our curriculum theme, **“Pitfall of National Consciousness,”** highlighting how revolutionary energy often dissipates without systemic transformation.

The selection of *“Heroes”* serves as an ironic yet hopeful counterpoint, suggesting resistance and fleeting moments of dignity even within oppressive realities.

Equipment we used:

- Camera: Blackmagic Pocket Cinema Camera 4K
- Lens: 14–140mm
- V-Mount Battery
- Camera Rig
- V60 Memory Card (Tough)
- Field Monitor (Feel world)

Crew list:

- **Cast:** Showmiq Islam Utshow
- **Director & Cinematographer:** Ebsan Zaman Dipto
- **Assistant Director:** Miad Hasan Ornob

- **Editor:** Masud Parves
- **Colorist:** N. A. Anik
- **Production Manager:** K. M. Schezade Haque

Equipment Support: Ulab Media Lab

Production Challenges

The production process was physically and logistically demanding, especially given the constraints of time, budget, and environment.

The primary challenge was shooting entirely on the **Blackmagic Pocket Cinema Camera 4K**. To sustain an 8-hour shoot, a full rig setup with a V-mount battery was required, bringing the total weight to approximately 4 kg. Navigating this heavy setup through the crowded streets of Dhaka proved extremely difficult.

Our locations included **Mirpur 10, Motijheel, and Diabari (Uttara)** all busy urban spaces. Shooting in such environments created constant interruptions, as crowds frequently looked into the camera, causing delays and requiring multiple retakes.

Another major obstacle was filming inside the metro rail without official permission. As a result, we had to shoot discreetly, which was particularly challenging given the size of our camera rig.

Weather also disrupted the schedule. Although we planned for bright daylight, the day began with rain and remained gloomy. At one point, we considered canceling the shoot. However, we adapted the visual tone of the narrative to embrace this gloominess, which ultimately enhanced the emotional depth of the story.

Our call time was 6:00 AM, but due to weather delays, we began shooting at 8:00 AM. Despite these setbacks, the team-maintained control and successfully completed production.

Post-Production

During editing, several visually creative shots were removed because they did not serve the narrative. This was a difficult but necessary decision to maintain storytelling clarity.

Ultimately, the final cut successfully conveys the intended thematic arc, capturing the character's emotional journey and reinforcing the central message of systemic stagnation.

Color & Visual Style

The color grading followed a stylized approach, incorporating **pink highlights and greenish shadows**. This palette was chosen to create an abstract, almost surreal environment, suggesting a distorted reality where the character feels trapped.

The intention was to evoke a “false sky” of hope, visually poetic but emotionally confining.

Budget & Schedule

The project was completed over **5 days** with a minimal budget of **6000 BDT**:

- **5000 BDT** – Production costs (transportation, props, food)
- **1000 BDT** – Camera rig rental

Reflection

This production was a test of endurance, adaptability, and creative discipline. Despite numerous challenges, from heavy equipment and unpredictable weather to restricted locations, we managed to complete the project without compromising its core vision.

The cast and crew played a crucial role in this success. The lead actor remained committed throughout the intense shooting schedule, while the team consistently supported both the technical and creative process.

In the end, the project stands as a reflection of both its narrative and its making, a story of struggle, persistence, and the quiet resilience required to continue, even when change seems impossible.

BTS:





Link of the Music Video: <https://youtu.be/7uPMbeTeXe4>



Clip 1 from Helden



Clip 2 from Helden



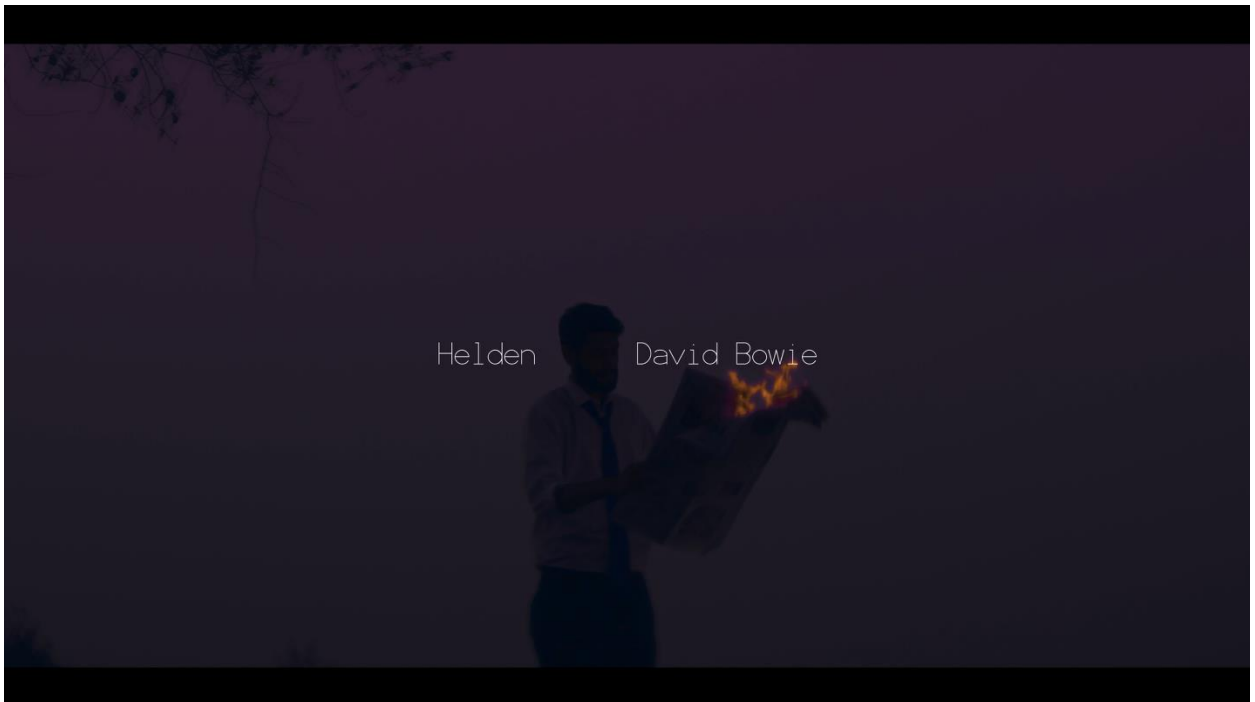
Clip 3 from Helden



Clip 4 from Helden



Clip 5 from Helden



Clip 6 from Helden

Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- I learned how to plan and shoot a music video under real-world constraints.
- I can now handle heavy camera equipment in crowded outdoor locations.
- I understood how to adapt creative decisions when weather or location problems occur.
- I learned how to lead a crew and manage production challenges on the spot.